G-E-550C
October 23, 1975
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. G-E-550b
May 7, 1963

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

ENVELOPE, PHOTOGRAPHIC NEGATIVE, PAPER

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers paper envelopes for filing and preserving photographic and X-ray, glass and film negatives.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types. The envelopes shall be of the following types (see 6.2):

Type I - Light
Type II - Medium
Type III - Heavy

1.2.2 Sizes. Nominal sizes of the envelopes shall be as specified (see 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications :

PPP-B-566	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	Boxes, Setup.

FSC 7530

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Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, and Standards, as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration, Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standard, and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications, and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting o officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following dpcuments form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Standard:

PH4.20 - Requirements for Photographic Filing Enclosures for Storing Processed Photographic Films, Plates and Papers.

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(Copies may be obtained from the American National Standards Institute, 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018.)

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry:

TAPPI T401	Fiber Analysis of Paper and Paperboard.
TAPPI T402	Standard Conditioning and Testing Atmospheres for Paper, Board, Pulp Handsheets and Related Products.
TAPPI T403	Bursting Strength of Paper.
TAPPI T410	Weight per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.
TAPPI T435	Hydrogen Ion Concentration (PH) of Paper Extracts Hot Extraction Method.

(Copies may be obtained from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 1 Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, GA 30341.)

Society of Dyers and Colorists Color Index:

(Copies may be obtained from the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists (AATCC), P.O. Box 12215, Research Triangle Park, NC 27709.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The materials of which the envelopes are made, and the physical and chemical properties of the manufactured envelope, shall meet the requirements of ANSI PH4.20 and shall also be as specified herein. Treatment of paper for protection against fungus growth is not required. Adhesive shall meet the requirements of ANSI PH4.20.

3.1.1 Paper weight and bursting strength. The basis weight and bursting strength of the paper used in the manufacture of the envelopes shall be as shown in table I when measured and tested in accordance with 4.4.1.1 and 4.4.1.2 respectively.

TABLE I. Physical properties of paper

Type of envelope	Basis weight (17 by 22, 1000 sheets) tolerance ± 5%	Bursting strength average (minimum)
	Pounds	Points
I	48	44
II	64	56
III	80	66

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3.1.2 Acidity (PH). The PH of the paper used in the manufacture of the envelopes shall be not less than 5.0 when tested in accordance with 4.4.1.3.

3.1.3 Fiber analysis. Fiber analysis shall be as specified in ANSI PH4.20 when tested as indicated in 4.4.1.4.

3.2 Construction. Envelopes shall be of the open-end type without seal flap, designated as a "jacket" in accordance with ANSI PH4.20. The open end shall have a finger cutout. Envelopes shall be fabricated of smooth light-colored kraft paper suitable for use in storage of photographic and X-ray, glass and film negatives.

3.2.1 Glued seams. Adhesive bonded seams shall have a fiber-tearing bond which secures the full length and width of the seams.

3.3 Ruling and writing properties. Lines ruled and characters written shall be sharp, clear, legible and shall not feather when tested as specified in 4.4.2.

3.4 Printing. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), each size envelope shall be furnished with the following printing placed in the upper left corner of the front side:

Patient's Name _____

Grade _____ Date _____

Case or Service No. _____

Organization _____

The overall length of the printing (headings and lines) shall be a minimum of three inches. The orientation of the envelope to the printing shall be either with the opening at the right end or at the top as specified (see 6.2). The distance between the lines of printing shall be one-half inch. The distance between the left edge of the envelope and the beginning of the printing shall be as specified (see 6.2).

3.5 Dimensions. The envelope dimensions shall be as specified (see 6.2), with a tolerance of ± 1/16 inch for each dimension.

3.6 Workmanship. The envelopes shall be free of holes, tears, stains, wrinkles and foreign matter. The envelope seams shall be adequately sealed without excess adhesive on either the inside or outside of the envelope. The printing shall be complete and legible.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificate of quality. Certificate of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the paper, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the Item Identification, the name of the component, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table II. Sample unit shall be one envelope.

TABLE II. For examination

	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
For visual examination		
Major defects	I	1.0
Minor defects	I	2.5
For dimensional examination	S-2	2.5

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4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table III.

TABLE III. For tests

Component (unit of product)	Characteristic (Test)	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL
* Envelope or basic paper	Basis weight	3.1.1	4.4.1.1	S-2	**
Envelope	Bursting strength	3.1.1	4.4.1.2	S-2	**
Envelope	Acidity (PH)	3.1.2	4.4.1.3	S-2	**
Envelope	Fiber analysis	3.1.3	4.4.1.4	S-2	**
Envelope	Ruling and writing properties	3.3	4.4.2	S-2	**

* Traceable to envelope sampling lot.
** Acceptance number shall be zero.

4.3 Examination. The envelopes shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.3.1 Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with the following table:

TABLE IV. Classification of defects *

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Envelope not free of tears or holes.
102	Envelope seams not adequately sealed.
103	Envelope not free of stains.
104	Printing not complete or legible.
105	Envelope not free of wrinkles.
106	Adhesive on inside of envelope.
Minor	
201	Envelope not free of foreign material.
202	Adhesive on outside of envelope.

* Examination shall not be restricted to the classified possible defects listed above.

4.3.2 Dimensional examination. The envelopes shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within the tolerance specified herein shall be classified as a defect.

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4.3.3 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine compliance with the packaging, packing and marking requirements of Section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in table V. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 with AQL of 4.0 expressed in terms of percent defective.

TABLE V. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defects
Contents	Not as specified.
Container	Not as specified.
Marking	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Packaging and packing materials	Component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Bulging or distortion of containers.

4.3.3.1 Examination of closure, waterproofing and banding of container. When the shipping container is required to comply with PPP-B-636, the examination for defects in closure, waterproofing or banding shall be in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Physical and chemical properties. Prior to tests, samples shall be conditioned as specified in TAPPI Standard T402.

4.4.1.1 Paper weight. Paper weight shall be determined by TAPPI Standard T410.

4.4.1.2 Bursting strength. Bursting strength shall be determined by TAPPI Standard T403.

4.4.1.3 Acidity (PH). Paper acidity shall be determined by TAPPI Standard T435.

4.4.1.4 Fiber analysis. Fiber analysis shall be determined by TAPPI Staudard T401.

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4.4.2 Ruling and writing properties. Using a 1-percent solution of either Color Index 18050,,C.I. Acid Red, or Color Index 42085 C.I. Acid Green 3, apply rulings and written characters to the envelopes with a fine printing pen.

4.4.3 Testing in ANSI PH4.20. Envelopes shall be tested for each characteristic stated in ANSI Standard PH4.20. Failure of any test specimen to meet the ANSI requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Inspection level shall be S-2.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be Level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in table VI shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

TABLE VI. Packaging quantities

Nominal size (inches)	Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
3 X 4-1/2	1 unit (100 envelopes)	12 units	96 units
4-3/8 X 10-3/8	1 unit (100 envelopes)	6 units	24 units
5-5/8 X 8-3/4	1 unit (250 envelopes)	Not required	10 units
8 X 10	1 unit (250 envelopes)	Not required	4 units
10 X 10	Not required	Not required	500 envelopes/case
14-1/2 X 17-1/2	1 unit (100 envelopes)	Not required	4 units
21 X 24-7/8	Not required	Not required	250 envelopes/case

5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Unit package. The number of envelopes specified in table VI, shall be packaged in a snug-fitting box constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Closure of the box shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

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5.1.2.2 Intermediate package. The number of units specified in table VI shall be packaged in a snug-fitting box constructed in accordance with PPP-B-676 or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.3 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. The number of units specified in table VI shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure, strapping and waterproofing shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. The number of units specified in table VI shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size and kind commonly used for the purpose, constructed so as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or purchase order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities.

5.3.2.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Control or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Envelopes covered by this specification are intended for filing and preserving photographic X-ray, glass and film negatives.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers shall select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Type required (see 1.2.1)
c. Size required (see 3.5).
d. Printing, orientation of envelope and distance between left edge and printing (see 3.4).
e. Applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:
GSA-FSS
HEW-HSM
VA-DMS

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 7530-0183

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

G-E-550C, Envelope, Photographic Negative, Paper

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

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☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

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